

Corrigendum

We apologize to our readers for wrongly publishing some details of the Acer Iconia W4 in the Windows tablet comparison test last month. It's specs were wrongly mentioned in the tablet of having 32GB storage (it comes with 64GB), and CPU speed of 1.3GHz (it's top burst speed is 1.8GHz, which wasn't mentioned). And while the tablet was 3G enabled, we wrongly suggested it of not having a SIM card slot. We will be more careful about verifying the information we publish in future.

Ultrabooks



ACER TravelMate P645

Powered by Intel's i5 4200U CPU and 8GB of RAM, the P645 should have more than adequate grunt for day-to-day use. You do get three USB 3.0 ports and the rest of the expected connectivity options, but there are two things that stand out with this laptop. The first is the touchpad, which is the best we've encountered in the test, and the second is the lack of a touch screen; an almost shocking omission in this category.

The P645 is an otherwise impressive device, but what will make or break the buying decision for you is your affinity to a touch-screen on a Windows-based laptop. We definitely feel that a touch-screen on a laptop, while not a pre-requisite, is a nice option to have.

It's a decent laptop, feature-wise, and buy it for the keyboard.

LENOVO Yoga 2 13

The Lenovo Yoga 2 is one of the few devices to offer a platform that elegantly embraces Windows 8's touch-friendly (or unfriendly, depending on your perspective) UI. As all of you must be aware by now, the Yoga's 360 degree hinge allows the device to seamlessly transition between traditional and pseudo-tablet modes.

The device isn't all about the hinge. It's very well-designed and even without the hinge, is a very capable and feature-rich device that'll give any Ultrabook a run for its money with its support for motion control (a bit gimmicky) and hardware volume and factory reset keys.

You only get one USB 3.0 port, which is a little disappointing, but it's really doubtful if you'll need more than one at a time anyway.

LENOVO IdeaPad Flex 2

Some call this the poor man's Yoga and we're inclined to agree. You lose out on the Yoga's 360 degree hinge in favour of a 300 degree (approximately) one. In the bargain, you pay ₹10,000 less, get a slightly larger screen and quite a bit more bulk.

The Flex 2 is definitely not a bad device, especially when you also consider the fact that it comes with a dedicated Nvidia GPU (but it's not a very powerful one). The Flex however, is overshadowed by the Yoga, which, for a slightly higher asking price, offers much more. Why would you buy a Mazda when you can get a Ferrari?

Using the same argument however, the Mazda might be less flamboyant, but also the more practical of the two (and cheaper). Ultimately we feel it's a personal preference here.

FEATURES

When you're in the market for an Ultrabook, there are certain features that you need to look out for, features that may not be essential, but will definitely make for a more pleasurable computing experience.

CPU: We can't stress this enough, if you're getting yourself an Ultrabook, get one that's powered by Intel's Haswell CPUs. The improvements in efficiency ensure the perfect balance of processing power and power consumption, a combination that ensures that your device is adequately powered and will offer excellent battery life. This is unmatched by any of other CPU family in the market today, even Intel's previous offerings.

Display: Try to aim for a 1080p display. While 1366x768 is sufficient at sub-14" screen sizes, it's definitely not as lovely as 1080p. At this resolution you'll be hard pressed to spot pixels on the screen and in the long-term, your eyes will definitely learn to appreciate the difference. Don't worry about scaling, Windows 8.1 has learnt from its past mistakes (some mistakes) and the DPI can be effectively scaled to compensate.

Also, while it's not required, aim for a device with a touch-screen. Windows 8 devices still don't support truly effective touchpad navigation and a touch-screen will be a noticeable advantage.

You might want to look out for external battery pack support too.

Specifications

Display.....14in LCD @ 1366x768
CPU..... Intel Core i5 4200U
RAM..... 8GB
Storage.....500GB HDD
GPU..... Intel HD 4400
OS..... Windows 8
Weight.....1.5 Kg
USB.....3xUSB 3.0
Misc.....No touch-screen, accelerometer

Specifications

Display..... 13.3in LCD @ 1080p
CPU..... Intel Core i5 4200U
RAM..... 4GB
Storage..... 500GB HDD
GPU..... Intel HD 4400
OS..... Windows 8.1
Weight.....1.6 Kg
USB.....1xUSB 3.0
Misc.....360 hinge, motion control

Specifications

Display..... 14in LCD @ 1080p
CPU..... Intel Core i5 4210U
RAM..... 4GB
Storage.....500GB HDD
GPU.....NVIDIA GeForce 820M
OS..... Windows 8.1
Weight.....1.89 Kg
USB.....1xUSB 3.0
Misc..... Hinge